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The Politic, Inc., "Yale Political Monthly 1992 May" (1992). *The Politic*. 30.
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# The Yale Political Monthly

*An Undergraduate Publication*

## The Fight For Yale's Future
*The Faculty's Plan Threatens Yale*

## Understanding the Carew Report
*Deciphering the Jargon and Revealing the Danger*

## Restructuring and the Threat to Yale College
*Dean Kagan's Address to the Students*

## GESO Deserves a Voice, not a Veto
*Collective Bargaining Has no Place in the Graduate School*

## Book Review
*The End of History and the Last Man*

VOLUME 13, NUMBER 4 ❦ MAY 1992

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We encourage responses and will print all thoughtful and well-written letters with appropriate authorial response in the hope of stimulating continued dialogue on campus. All written material should be submitted to the Editor or mailed to the YPM. Students wishing to join the staff of the YPM should contact the Editor at 436-3081.

The Staff of the YPM wishes to extend its thanks to Gideon Rose, Adam Freedman, Robert Kagan, Fareed Zakaria, Frederick Kagan, and John Kuszewski for their invaluable advice and assistance.

The Yale Political Monthly is a non-profit undergraduate organization. For subscription information, contact the Editor.

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VOLUME 13, NUMBER 4
MAY, 1992

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# The Fight for Yale's Future

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*Linette Hwu*

One would not think that it was still necessary to discuss the sorry state of Yale's buildings, or the necessity that every member of the Yale community do his part to help Yale through a difficult time. The report of the Review Committee of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, however, has made it clear that some members of this community, at least, have chosen to ignore the obvious and plentiful evidence of this crisis in the pursuit of their own ambitions. The central assertion of the Carew Report, submitted on 5 March to the Faculty of Arts and Sciences (FAS), is that the faculty is at the center of Yale's outstanding reputation as a prestigious academic establishment. There is no doubt that the scholarship of the Yale College faculty is respected all over the world and that it presents Yale students with unique educational opportunities.

*A 1986 survey of the condition of the books in the stacks revealed that in 40% of them the paper was already brittle*

The Carew Report says that "to pass on to future generations a greatly enlarged endowment and enhanced facilities, at the cost of a diminished academic enterprise, would be a disservice to both present and future generations." [Page 3] But this statement ignores the bigger problem that there will be no academic enterprise at all if the quality of the buildings on Yale's Campus is allowed to deteriorate at the current rate, and that would surely be an even greater disservice.

Furthermore, when one of the buildings which is in such serious disrepair is Sterling Memorial Library, which houses 4 million volumes in one of the largest research collections in the country, even more attention must be paid. The loss of books through the steady erosion of wind and water in the stacks is one which threatens to get steadily worse. This kind of damage, the destruction of books caused by the entrance of natural elements into the library, is irreparable, for some of the books are irreplaceable, except for the expensive alternative of transferring damaged books onto microfilm (on the average, $70 per volume) or perhaps eventually the process of mass deacidification ($7-10 per volume).

According to Gerald Lowell, Associate University Librarian and Director of Technical Services, a 1986 survey of the condition of the books in the stacks indicated that in 40% of them the paper was already brittle, that is, it could not survive two folds. Another 40% of the books were composed of highly acidic paper, that is, the paper was well on its way towards becoming brittle. Lowell added, "We are literally in a race against time in an attempt to preserve our cultural and scholastic heritage. Yale's collection of books is one of its largest capital assets, probably the largest that the University has, and people forget that."

Of course, the state of the books is made even worse by what Lowell called "deplorable conditions in the stacks." In particular, he cited routine floods because of bursting pipes in the heating and cooling systems, wall and roof damage which creates leaks, and windows which do not close and sometimes pop open during New Haven rainstorms, letting in enormous amounts of wind and water. The worst thing, however, is the wide range in temperature and humidity in the stacks; instability in climatic conditions is even more dangerous than constant heat or constant humidity.

"We're talking multi-millions of dollars for building repair," said Lowell. "The situation is already out of hand." According to Lowell, the plans for building renovations are being examined by outside contractors, but what is most needed is repair for the outside structure of the Library, followed by a complete overhaul of the

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inner systems of the Library, such as the plumbing, electrical, and heating systems. If Sterling Memorial Library is not renovated quickly, the situation will worsen, and fewer and fewer books will be available for circulation among students and faculty. Instead, books will only be available for use within the Library because of their extreme fragility, if they have not already been totally destroyed.

It is not only Sterling Memorial Library, which is in grave danger of decay beyond redress; several other campus buildings have been discussed in past issues of the YPM. More importantly, however, the condition of residential colleges requires attention.

Take, for example, the case of room 1359 in Davenport. Over spring break, the valve on one of the radiators popped off. This had happened before, but when students were around; they were able to call Physical Plant and ask them to turn off the heat in their room so that they could replace the valve after the radiator had cooled down. When the students were not there, however, nothing was done until a neighboring student who had stayed in town noticed steam and water seeping out from underneath the door. He called the police, who opened the door to find the room transformed into a tropical jungle and the radiator spewing steam and water like a geyser. Everything was drenched–books, posters, tapestries, sofas, lamps, computers, stereo–the floor was covered by an inch of water, and the plaster was peeling off the walls. The radiator was fixed by Physical Plant workers before the students returned from spring break, but the plaster peeled for nearly another a week before the walls were replastered, and the floor remains a dull hardwood.

Or take the even worse example of room 1167 in Trumbull. The students noticed a leak in a corner and called both the Physical Plant and the Trumbull Building Supervisor to fix the problem. It took several phone calls before anyone came to look at the leak, and upon arrival the workers informed the students that the piping would have to be fixed, and that it would be done at the beginning of winter break. Instead, the Physical Plant workers came to amend the leak problem at the end of winter break, by which time the room had already been flooded and student property ruined. It then became necessary for the students to move out of the room until the work was completed, but once they moved back in, the leak still proved to be a problem, because it had been fixed incorrectly. The students did not move into a properly repaired room until close to spring break.

Poor residential college conditions do not affect only the students. English Professor Claude Rawson has had his office in room 592 in the Berkeley tunnel since 1987. Despite being what he considers one of the finer and larger offices Yale offers its faculty, the room has had a wall or ceiling pulled out every year since he arrived. Two years ago, a leak in the north wall ruined $1800 worth of Latin books, and a year later a similar leak in the west wall destroyed an additional $600-$700 of Greek books. But the situation has become even graver since May 1991. Professor Rawson was to take a leave of absence this year to begin a new project, and returned to his office in July to spend five intense weeks finishing an incomplete book before that. Upon arrival he once again discovered leaks on both the north and west walls; this time Physical Plant assured him that they could finish their work in four days so that his work could begin immediately.

Physical Plant finished the repairs in eight months.

In November, Professor Rawson had to submit his book incomplete to the publisher and still had not yet started his new project. That work did not begin until he was informed in February 1992 that his water problems were solved. Last month, however, he went to the south wall of the office to refer to an issue of a priceless collection of a journal which he had published for over thirty years, only to discover that the center had been ravaged by termites. As he pulled more and more books off of the south wall, he found bullet-size holes in almost all of them; the damage was estimated at $5200. Physical Plant informed him that they had noted this problem elsewhere in his vicinity, but had solved it a year earlier, and so he could be assured that the termites were all dead. But when Professor Rawson placed several books on the floor one night so that photographs could be taken the next morning, he returned to work the next day to find live termites crawling all over them. He estimates that 40% of his leave has been completely lost. Moreover, these damage figures do not take into account the fact that he has still not checked many of his books for damage. Neither does it include the many books which were dampened, soaked or whose

*If the library is not quickly repaired, many books may be damaged beyond recovery*

pages are stuck together because Berkeley's dehumidifying system has proved inadequate in draining the air of moisture from the swamp above which all of Cross Campus was built.

These are only three examples of deteriorating dormitory and college conditions. Others abound, particularly in Wright Hall on the Old Campus and in Jonathan Edwards College. A thorough examination of Yale's facilities conducted in 1988 while William Nordhaus was Provost revealed extensive damage in the residential colleges. For example, the members of Nordhaus' housing subcommittee found "extensive paint and plaster damage from leakage, floors in squash courts ruined by water, ceilings with water damage, and floors in student rooms buckling from leaky radiators. In several basements the committee saw major equipment sitting in pools of water arising from continuous leaks." They concluded that "delay will only lead to further expense," an argument which has since been dismissed by the Carew Committee. It is also interesting to note that since Nordhaus' return to the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, he has become one of the most vocal critics of a program which, as he put it, "puts buildings in front of people." Professor Joseph La Palombara is also currently one of the Administration's most outspoken critics, yet in 1988 he headed Nordhaus' subcommittee on non-scientific academic facilities, which found and decried similarly sorry conditions. For example, they noted in their report that "heating and cooling systems appear to function randomly, creating pockets and zones that are overheated in some instances, grossly underheated in others."

*Since Nordhaus' return to the faculty he has become one of the most vocal critics of a program which "puts buildings before people"—and which he had supported as provost*

For the residential colleges to pass muster with modern living standards, extensive renovations are needed on the level of those done in Calhoun College in 1989, with external repair to take place before work on the internal systems (plumbing, electrical, heating) can begin. The work done on Calhoun cost $22 million. Multiplied by the 11 remaining colleges, the grand total comes to $242 million. The Administration's integrated plan calls for completing renovations in the next ten years, thus, more than $24 million a year needs to be spent merely on improving the colleges. That figure is a conservative one which hopes that the wait of ten years will not serve to send costs skyrocketing. But the Carew Report argues that exactly $24 million a year should be spent in the total capital budget, and that the payments should be spread out over thirty years. That equals thirty more years of deterioration, increased costs, and budgets that can barely provide for routine maintenance or improvements, let alone both.

Under the plan of outgoing Provost Frank Turner (he holds his position until July), part of the money needed for these renovations, and for the renovations of other Yale buildings, would come from faculty cuts in various departments and, in some cases, the complete elimination of departments which, in cost-benefit analyses by *ad hoc* committees, were deemed expendable.

This proved unacceptable, however, to the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, and as a result, the Carew Report shows nothing but a self-centered, retrogressive concern for the preservation of the teaching positions of faculty members, and places little or no importance on the maintenance and quality of buildings on the Yale campus. Rather, it recommends "lowering the intended expenditures on buildings," and claims that "improvement in the quality of buildings benefits future generations as well as the current generation; [therefore,] it seems appropriate that those generations share the costs." In other words, work on renovations should be continually postponed for indefinite periods of time extending into the future until individual situations become so terrible that something has to be done by Physical Plant.

How can this "plan" possibly contribute to the quality of the academic institution Yale is? As it is, Physical Plant does very little in the way of routine maintenance; rather, it is constantly responding to emergencies. According to 1990 statistics, the Physical Plant devotes half of its time towards routine maintenance and emergency repair and another half towards plant maintenance. According to Roberto Meinrath, Deputy Director for Facilities Management, approximately two-thirds of the former half goes toward emergency repairs. If the Carew Report's recommendations are enacted, and nothing is done to insure the survival of Yale buildings later, then emergencies can be expected to increase in frequency and gravity, and the Physical Plant will have little time for anything other than responding to emergencies. Furthermore, one should note that unless a Physical Plant worker takes an axe and hacks a student's room to pieces, Yale is not responsible for any damage that may occur to student property, which includes damage as a

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result of leaky radiators, pipes, and so on. These considerations certainly contribute to Physical Plant's slowness and sometimes total failure to take action against building deterioration. Meinrath said, "There is no escaping the fact that the University has to invest in building maintenance, and I don't think there is any dispute that a significant amount [of money] needs to be invested." He cited the minimum, just to meet electrical and plumbing needs, as being between $20 and $30 million.

The Carew Report also recommends that the best means of cutting budget spending is to cut administrative and staff support, reasoning that this is a more appropriate austerity measure than cutting faculty positions because the integrity of the faculty is more important than such support services.

The Carew Report claims that the plan for a 10.7% cut is an unfair share and too large a burden for the FAS to bear, but, of course, every other facet of the College has already had to deal with cuts. The first budget cuts were designed to insure that the administration would run at a bare minimum; the second series of cuts hit student services, which cuts are still being implemented, such as the 16% cut in custodial services announced for next year. The only administrative area in which cuts have not yet been made is in the department of alumni relations, the problems with which are obvious. Beyond that, removing the positions of the Assistant Deans of Yale College, or the Dean of Student Affairs, or cuts within residential college masters' and deans' offices would certainly have negative results for students, by removing a means of communication with the administration and thus presenting an obstacle to good relations between the administration and the students, as well as by removing some of the administrative officials whose primary, if not sole, concern is to deal with student issues.

Betty Trachtenberg, for example, currently serves as the Dean of Student Affairs. Her responsibilities include making policy on all undergraduate organizations, coordinating Freshman Orientation and the freshman counselor program, working with the residential college masters on student activities, overseeing housing on Old Campus and in the residential colleges, minority advising, and supervision of the Assistant Deans. Clearly the elimination of her position would be "devastating," as she herself told the YPM, because it would leave serious gaps in the administrative supervision of student affairs and would force other administrators to take up matters with which they are neither familiar nor qualified to supervise.

And there can be no question that eliminating jobs in custodial services, the dining halls, or the athletic facilities would be unfortunate for the students as well. These areas have already endured significant cuts, and there have already been complaints in the dining halls of the overextension of employees as a result of fewer jobs. Further cuts in these areas would surely mean more inconveniences for students, in addition to the sacrifice of quality in all of those areas.

The Carew Report divides the various segments of the university into self-supporting and non-self-supporting parts. "The Medical School budget is now in balance and is expected to remain in balance as the School undertakes its own capital program." Because of this, the Report suggests that the Medical School contribute to the reconstitution of the budget of the university as a whole. "The non-self-support[ing] schools that are under a great deal of financial pressure, and are subsidized by the Center [a base of $265 million which includes all of the FAS expenditures and revenues, but only includes the subsidies to the professional schools], are part of what makes Yale a great intellectual and cultural treasure. Some of the responsibility for preserving their presence should be borne by the more prosperous schools."

Essentially, the Medical School should be punished for its ability to maintain a balanced budget by forcing it to become part of the university's plan to re-work the budget. That is simply ludicrous. Such a solution fails to solve the problem at bottom, which is that there are areas in which budget cuts can legitimately be made so that the money needed for things such as building repair can be allocated for that purpose, and instead only threatens to bring the Medical School into the same financial mire in which the College is currently trapped.

This logic is further flawed because it claims that buildings such as Woolsey Hall, Woodbridge Hall, and the Cullman Courts are used by all of the professional schools, not simply by the College, and thus all of the professional schools should pay for their renovation. But none of these three structures, which are specifically mentioned as examples in the Carew Report, are scheduled

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*Further cuts to administration and support services would do great harm to the quality of undergraduate life*

for any of the renovations which Provost Turner's plan outlined. Rather, it is Linsley-Chittenden and the residential colleges which need a great deal of maintenance work, and these are certainly used primarily by the College.

It is not especially surprising that the FAS has no desire and no interest in bearing the brunt of the costs for building repair–human nature dictates that one usually wants to maintain a beneficial *status quo*, and at the very least, not suffer from a change in the *status quo* – but the blunt fact remains that if the faculty does not pay its fair share, the students will have to endure even more sacrifices than they already have: by losing the buildings which contribute so much to the learning atmosphere here at Yale, not only architecturally but also by virtue of being the places where one lives and learns, and by sacrificing the quality of facilities such as Payne-Whitney Gymnasium and the residential college dining halls, which a university must have.

Where does that leave Yale now, considering the recent developments in the structure of the administration? Obviously, there is no real way of knowing whether or not Provost Turner was actually ousted. Still, all the facts point to such an action–for example, Provost Turner's adamant opposition to compromise, the speed in naming a successor, Provost Turner's resulting lack of control or influence over the whole issue–and indicate only fear on the part of President Schmidt. His fear is that Provost Turner's plan for the restructuring of Yale would incur such anger from the Faculty of Arts and Sciences as to make it inadvisable and disadvantageous to proceed with it.

*Not satisfied with spiking the Administration's attempts to repair Yale's buildings, the faculty is attempting to take yet more direct control of the University*

Yale, then, is left with division and uncertainty during a critical moment, which requires a specific plan to solve a crisis. Of course, there may be no longer be any need for any such carefully delineated plan. The resignation of Dean Donald Kagan, the last member of the administration who understood and championed the need for the implementation of Provost Turner's plan, or one similar in scope and direction, leaves the Faculty of Arts and Sciences apparently triumphant.

The arrogance of the faculty, however, goes even further. In the recently created Governance Committee, faculty members have pushed for the creation of the position of Dean of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences. This proposition, in addition to being an overt declaration of political ambition, will inevitably lead to the "Harvardization" of Yale University. The position, which was introduced in Cambridge in the 1950s, will probably be given almost dictatorial powers over academic issues that may solely concern Yale College and should be decided, therefore, by the Dean of Yale College. It was this system, indeed, that imposed the core curriculum on Harvard College. This is undesirable, for it essentially means more faculty research, less faculty teaching, and more graduate student teaching, thus destroying the central role of Yale undergraduates. As Dean Kagan noted in his speech, the uniqueness of Yale's "devotion to the liberal education of undergraduates, even as it has become an international center of scientific research and humanistic scholarship" would be lost.

The present disagreements leave Yale in desperate need of some source of additional funding for the sake of its existence and the quality of that existence as one of the most prestigious institutions of higher learning in the world. The Carew Report recommends the creation of *ad hoc* committees to study the need for the budget overhaul, for the different budget cuts; this essentially means pushing back decisions and postponing action. As Robert Heinlein has written, "a committee is a life form with six or more legs and no brain;" unfortunately, the buildings of the Yale campus very much need a brain to oversee their renovation and continued existence.

The present chaos leaves Yale with a large portion of its community unwilling to cooperate just as it is about to launch its major fund-raising campaign. This is a serious liability in that fund-raising campaign, and the Faculty of Arts and Sciences must be seen as an overtly selfish actor in its desire to remain unaffected by changes which must be made and which must affect all facets of the Yale community. Everyone who benefits from the opportunities and advantages which Yale has to offer, the faculty not least, should bear a portion of the burden for the immense cost and sacrifice it will require for Yale's survival and growth. It is sad that the very members of the Yale community who, attached to the University for the longest time, should best appreciate its long-run interests have chosen instead to try to force the Administration to serve their immediate, narrow ambitions.

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# Understanding the Carew Report

*Carlos Viana*



The stillborn "Report of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences Review Committee," formed in response to the Restructuring Committee's recommendations for budget cuts, bases most of its arguments on the essential elements of all economic analyses: the minimization of costs and the maximization of utility to Yale University. Such a technical approach comes as no surprise since a considerable number of the members of the Carew Committee come from the Economics Department. The real surprise is that what could have been a valuable, objective methodology of analysis was turned into a fine collection of inconsistencies, contradictions, mistaken assumptions, and deliberately politicized recommendations aimed at serving the interests of a part of Yale's faculty, and not the interests of Yale University as a whole, much less those of Yale College. It is of vital importance, therefore, to assess the main arguments of the Carew Report and to disentangle the remarkable collection of interdisciplinary academic jargon which has made the Carew Report not only a threat to Yale College and Yale University, but also an almost incomprehensible piece of writing.

One of the few things the Carew Report does get right is its description of the components of Yale's wealth. Wealth, an important economic concept, is the ultimate constraint by which the calculus of budget cut choices should be maximized. According to the Report, Yale's wealth consists of the endowment, the libraries, museums, laboratories, other physical facilities, scholars, teachers, students, and loyal alumni, as well as Yale's tradition in liberal education. Once the Report has defined wealth, however, and has recognized the necessity of preserving Yale's wealth, it reduces the lengthy equation mentioned above to only three terms–the endowment, the physical plant, and the faculty–leaving aside students' quality of life, recruitment, alumni interests, and others.

The Report presents a tricky evaluation of the endowment's performance *vis-a-vis* faculty fluctuations. It presents the 1970s and 1980s period as one in which faculty growth was stagnant while the endowment grew rapidly. The Report ignores the fact that the endowment grew not only because of a good financial performance, but also because of dramatically reduced spending overall, which in turn decreased the rate of spending out of the endowment. The lack of growth in the faculty, therefore, was not a policy of austerity limited to the faculty. It is precisely because of this lack of spending in the 1980s, in fact, especially of capital investment in Yale's facilities, that we now face a crisis in our physical plant. It is precisely in this area of the Report that most of the mistaken maximizing assumptions occur.

*To bolster its demand for a retardation of the capital plan the Carew Report invents the dubious notion of "intergenerational equity"*

The argument goes that under the Restructuring Committee's plan not only does "the Center," Yale College and the Graduate School, pay for an unfair share of the physical restoration expenses, but also our generation carries an unfair share of the burden. The Report, therefore, calls for the establishment of "intergenerational equity." In order to achieve this equity, it suggests that the physical restoration expenses be reduced from the $46 million annually for 11 years proposed by the Restructuring Committee to $24 million annually for 30 years. According to the Carew Report, this will permit Yale to maintain the "average quality" of its buildings. The average quality of these buildings, however, is rapidly approaching zero and in other articles the YPM has consistently pointed out the embarrassing and dangerous conditions of many of our

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*Extending the repairs over a longer period of time is inefficient and risky*

facilities. By denying the existence of a budget crisis, the Carew Report not only fails to see the overarching problems we are facing, but it also turns away donors by implying that the problem lies not with the buildings but with capital planning: "Yale's capital plan is the source of the budget problem." This statement is a complete distortion of reality, completely ignoring the fact that the budget is merely an attempt to solve the horrific physical conditions at Yale. Although the original "White Paper" suggested that only half of the yearly expenditure ($23 million) was to be dedicated to improvements, the Carew Report calls for a total annual expenditure of $24 million, only $1 million more than what the White Paper estimated to be the cost of maintenance alone! $1 million a year for the next 30 years will clearly not be sufficient to improve the campus.

In addition, the Carew Report incorrectly assumes that the real price of both renovation and maintenance will remain constant for future generations, since it only accounts for inflation as the source of future increases in prices. Such an assumption, however, is dangerous. First, the growth of physical disintegration is likely to be exponential rather than linear. As a popular Spanish saying goes: He who does not fix the leaks in the roof, fixes the whole house. With time, overcrowding and sub-optimal janitorial services, together with the short-sighted maintenance (not improvement) program proposed by the Committee, will destroy Yale's facilities. Second, extending the period of time over which repairs are to be made is inefficient and risky. As one proceeds further into the future, predictions both of inflation and of other costs become steadily less reliable. The Carew Report, however, shortly before proposing to extend the building program further into the future attacks the Restructuring Committee for proposing a plan "fraught with uncertainty" when it attempted to plan spending only 10 years into the future.

The question of "intergenerational equity" must, indeed, be addressed. We should ask, therefore, if the Carew Committee should base its calculus of budget choice on maximizing the utility of those currently active in the Yale community, or of Yale's institutional well-being for an indefinite amount of time into the future. The maximization of Yale's interests in the long run is infinitely more important than the equal division of payments. The problem of minimizing cost, then, does not depend on "intergenerational equity" but on "intergenerational maximization." In this way it would be Yale's utility that is maximized and not the utility of any particular group which will be related to the institution only for a finite amount of time. Thus, it does not matter which generation actually pays for the costs of renovation as long as the costs are minimized. Since the price will eventually have to be paid in any case, it should be done now, when it is cheaper, and when it is certain. It is cheaper and safer to do it now so as to avoid the risk of unexpected future increases in cost. By doing it now, the increasing rate of growth of deterioration will also be minimized.

The Carew Report asserts that cutting the faculty by 10.7% will do great and irreparable harm to Yale's wealth. This argument is defeated by history, however. In the 1970s, the faculty was cut not by 10.7% but by 15%, and not over 10 years but over only 3 years. And we are still here, and we are still the best.

In a spirit of hysterical self-preservation, the Carew Report suggested that faculty be cut by a flat 5%, instead of the proposed pro/regressive 10.7% system. To compensate for this change, they suggest that non-faculty staff be cut by an additional 3.5%. This position reflects the Report's assumption that it is inherently better to fire non-faculty employees than to reduce the faculty, which is to be done entirely by attrition. Cutting the faculty according to the administration's plan means a reduction of slots, but not necessarily of personnel. A tenured professor occupies two slots, and when

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he retires or resigns he may be replaced by one tenured professor, or two junior professors, or sometimes only one junior faculty member is hired and one slot is left open. The plan to cut the faculty by attrition involves an active determination to leave at least one slot open in such cases. Thus the actual cut in the number of faculty members will be lower than the cut in the number of slots.

The "untouchable faculty" is further deified by the Carew Report's commitment to "academic welfare." Another of the Report's unfortunate suggestions is that professional schools which manage to have a surplus in their budget, such as the Medical School, should pay for the deficit in other institutional areas. Once again, the Faculty of Arts and Sciences is most concerned to avoid having "Yale College, the Graduate School and its faculty bear an unfair share of the cost," but they propose that the Medical School finance the University's deficit, and itself bear an unfair share of the cost. The implications of the Committee's "academic welfare" initiatives for other areas of restructuring would be even more disastrous. Although no departments should be eliminated, the establishment of welfare principles as the basis of financing academic life and compensating for inefficiency is improper and immoral. Departments as well as other institutional divisions that face economic, organizational, and academic problems must not be given a free ride.

The Carew Report, therefore, is a threat to Yale College and the quality of life of its students for now and for many years to come. It gravely threatens the efficient and cost-effective amelioration of the physical facilities, the improvement of academic programs, the recruitment of talented students, the level of support services, and Yale's tradition of being the world's best college at the center of a major research University. The Carew Committee, by instituting a regime of "academic welfare" based on incorrect assumptions and double-standards, which grants the faculty immunity from the problems which face the whole community, has dashed the hopes of many students who were expecting an outstanding paper from such an outstanding group of people. It would be a pity if such a harmful plan were implemented.



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# Restructuring and the Threat to Yale College

*Donald Kagan*

At the March meeting of the Yale College Faculty the Review Committee of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences made its report. Established only a month earlier, its assignment was to study the Yale administration's White Paper which assessed the financial problems facing the university as well as the report of the Restructuring Committee which recommended cuts in faculty positions and changes in organization meant to address some of those problems. The Review Committee's report was greeted with loud and prolonged applause, and its members deserved it. They had worked extraordinarily hard for long hours to digest information it had taken teams of faculty and administrators a year to compile and study, and to evaluate judgments and recommendations they had arrived at after many months of discussion and debate.

*Only the heat and pressure of the moment can explain so narrow a vision as that which emerges from the Committee's report*

I have no doubt that the applause was also in approval of the Review Committee's recommendations, the gist of which I would paraphrase as follows:

> We don't believe that Yale faces a financial crisis. Perhaps it faces some financial problems, but these are not very serious. To the extent the problems are real, solve them by retarding the pace of repairing Yale's buildings, solve them by further cuts in administrative staff, solve them at the expense of the professional schools. Only then, if necessary, should you reduce the number of faculty positions: not, however, by the 10.7% over ten years envisaged by the report of the Restructuring Committee, but by less than half of that.

Since each of the four recommendations made by the Review Committee was estimated to save about 5% it was easy to see that the adoption of even one of them would make it unnecessary to cut any faculty positions at all. One faculty member, swiftly calculating, pointed out that by adopting all four we could even increase the size of the faculty.

The Review Committee consisted of outstanding members of the Yale faculty, respected, public-spirited, thoughtful, and hard-working almost beyond belief. That is why I asked them to serve, and I am grateful for their efforts. With the greatest respect, however, I am forced to disagree with their assessment and some of their conclusions, which were arrived at, I believe, in a context that made the outcome of their deliberations all but inevitable. It is a context of frenzied denial and defensiveness, which, I suppose, is natural when a group of proud and powerfully independent people faces a change that seems to challenge some of its interests.

Only the heat and pressure of such an atmosphere, it seems to me, can explain so narrow a vision as that which emerges from the Committee's report. The pursuit of that vision, I believe, would do enormous harm to the quality of undergraduate education, especially to the quality of the life of undergraduates, at Yale. The pursuit of that vision would be an important part of what I see as a growing assault on Yale College and on the liberal education of undergraduates as the central activity of our great university.

At the heart of the Review Committee's report is the proposal to retard the repair and improvement of Yale's buildings. "Yale's capital plan," the report says, "is the main source of its budget problem." A proposed solution is to reduce the pace of making the needed repairs as currently planned: "Reduce the Capital Plan" is its first recommendation. The Review Committee also suggests stretching the payments out over thirty years. Since "improvement in the average quality of buildings will benefit future generations," the committee says, "it seems appropriate that the cost of the enhance-

*A full reprint of Dean Kagan's speech on 13 April 1992.*

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ments be shared with future generations." This last suggestion sounds less like the work of a group of scholars than like that of the United States Congress. Some faculty members have expressed the general idea with the slogan "Don't put buildings before people," a sound byte worthy of a modern political campaign but unworthy of serious people. The issue, of course, is not of putting buildings ahead of people but of putting the ambitions of one set of people ahead of the needs of others. It is a slogan easy to recite for those who are not living in or relying on the buildings for the quality of their daily lives and for the context in which their education takes place.

Yale has rightly been proud of its commitment to the highest quality in all aspects of an undergraduate education, curricular, extracurricular, and informal. We have recognized that the physical environment is a vital part of that quality. It is not only the idea of residential colleges that has helped attract the best students in the world to Yale but the beauty of those colleges and the excellence of the facilities they provide. Most of them are now more than fifty years old and badly in need of repair and modernization.

In 1988 Provost William Nordhaus launched a thorough inquiry into the conditions of Yale's facilities and its capital needs. The members of his faculty subcommittee investigating the condition of the residential colleges "found themselves genuinely shocked by what they encountered." They found extensive water damage caused both by leaks from antiquated heating systems and by seepage from the outside:

> extensive paint and plaster damage from leakage, floors in squash courts ruined by water, ceilings with water damage, and floors in student rooms buckling from leaky radiators. In several basements the committee saw major equipment sitting in pools of water arising from continuous leaks.

They found a heating system that made some student rooms stifling and left others ice-cold. They found plumbing systems with "backed-up drains, stopped up sinks, inoperable toilets...rusting pipes over showers, and inoperable showers." In the students' rooms they found that "electrical outlets are inadequate not only for standard lighting but also for the computers now in many rooms. Elaborate, dangerous use of extension cords is pervasive." The light fixtures were often broken and sometimes unrepairable.

The housing subcommittee concluded by finding the capital needs of Yale's residential buildings "immediate and pressing." They reported a "state of advanced and continuing deterioration." They found that

> matters of code compliance, student safety and comfort, alumni relations, as well as the structural decay call for action. There is really little choice for the University except to undertake a systematic program of repair and renovation over the next decade. Delay will only lead to further expense.

Some people have objected to the cost of the proposed program of repair and renovation on the grounds that such efforts at Yale are too elegant and, therefore, too expensive. Provost Nordhaus' subcommittee on residential facilities came to different conclusions. They found that in the repairs and renovations they observed,

> quality in design, materials, and workmanship has been abandoned to a shocking degree. Often there seems to have been only one criterion: to do the job as cheaply as possible. Ugly, inexpensive fluorescent fixtures have been crudely installed in once-grand rooms...a damaged wooden panel in a college common room has been replaced with construction grade plywood, crudely stained to match the old paneling surrounding it. This approach both reflects and reinforces the extraordinary decline that has occurred in the University community's sense of pride in its physical facilities.

Classrooms and other academic facilities are also important to the quality of an undergraduate education. A different provostial subcommittee, the one on non-scientific academic facilities, ably led by Professor Joseph La Palombara, made the following observations in 1988:

> The university's physical patrimony is in a very sorry state. This is true not just of buildings that have been part of the landscape for a century or more; it is so even in cases of much newer structures, or of buildings that have had recent major overhauls...
>
> Enough is awry from a structural standpoint to warrant deep concern. Sub-committee members who conducted on-site inspections were often shocked at what they found. Few of us imagined the magnitude of the university's physical decline. The evidence is overwhelming that intervention is urgently required to stem even further degeneration, and to ameliorate conditions that are oftentimes simply disgraceful.
>
> It is only the rare roof at Yale that is free from leaks...
>
> Ground floor facilities often flood; and below-ground rooms are dark and musty. In some cases the latter have been closed off by authorities as health



*"Don't put buildings before people" is a slogan easy to recite for those who do not rely on the buildings for the quality of their daily lives and the context of their education*

> hazards, because of mould growing there. Water-damaged walls and ceilings eventually release their plaster, sometimes abruptly, only to be badly repaired and subject to similar deterioration within a short time...
>
> In many of the older buildings, heating and cooling systems appear to function randomly, creating pockets and zones that are overheated in some instances, grossly underheated in others...
>
> In addition, some past alterations have been effected with a mindless disregard for the integrity of buildings, including those of considerable artistic and/or historical value. In some cases...maintenance is so poor that additional physical damage will make it impossible to replace what has been harmed...
>
> Essentially everyone agrees that the most urgent task regarding capital expenditures is to improve the university's capacity to teach, to conduct research, and to attract to Yale those who do both of these things exceptionally well. A vital need in this regard, forcefully brought to our attention by everyone, is to upgrade the university's abysmal classroom facilities.

Such were the observations of thoughtful members of the faculty who had examined the condition of Yale's facilities, but the Review Committee says "Reduce the Capital Plan."

Some progress has been made in the intervening years: a fine teaching laboratory has been restored at Osborne, the classrooms and faculty offices in Harkness Hall have been greatly improved, and Calhoun College has been splendidly renovated, which shows what can and must be done and also how expensive it will be. Still, the condition of most of the buildings where undergraduates reside, study, and find recreation, are little, if at all, better than they were in 1988. The fact is that the allocation in the Administration's integrated plan, not to mention the reduced allocation recommended by the Review Committee, devoted to maintaining and repairing buildings essential to the life of undergraduates, is far too low, falling well short of what is needed. The administration's current plan, much reduced already in the face of faculty criticism, calls for the expenditure of an average of $44 million in constant 1991 dollars annually for ten years on Yale's non-medical buildings. Included in that figure, however are $4 million each year for inescapable improvements, $2 million for essential security improvements, $4 million for required improvements in fire safety, and an unknown number of millions of dollars for mandatory improvement of access for the disabled and removal of asbestos for protection of health. Even, then, if the full sum planned were actually available, only $30 million annually would be available for repairs and renovations. But will the full sum be there? Only a very optimistic forecast permits such an expectation. Of the $44 million only $18 million is to be funded from debt annually. That is the only spending on which we can count. The rest must come from gifts. In recent years Yale has received only about $5 million annually for spending on non-Medical building renovations. Each year for ten years, therefore, we would need to increase such donations more than five fold to meet an already modest goal for building renovations, yet the Review Committee urges the lowering of the target to spare faculty positions. But to delay the needed renovations by reducing expenditures for them is to punish not some yet-to-be-conceived members of some future generation, but every class that enters Yale until the renovations have been made. Every year of delay will diminish the attractiveness of Yale College to the students we wish to bring here and damage the experience of those who choose to come.

*Every year of delay will diminish the attractiveness of Yale College to the students we wish to bring here and damage the experience of those who choose to come*

Provost Nordhaus' subcommittee on residential facilities had an appropriately broad understanding of what is important in an educational environment, so its members also addressed the problem of crowding. Here is what they found:

> The overcrowding of the residential colleges manifests itself on a number of levels all of which are detrimental to the educational mission of Yale College.
>
> Overcrowding and lack of privacy in the colleges has become, unfortunately, a way of life. Yet general acceptance of these circumstances does not mitigate their effects on human behavior. Numerous research studies show detrimental mental and physical health effects directly related to overcrowding, and the concomitant experience of lack of privacy. A sense of control and predictability over one's personal space, even with objective crowding, appears to reduce these toxic effects to some degree. But efforts to establish a bit of personal space often detrimentally influence social relationships under overcrowded conditions, potentially further raising levels of stress.
>
> There is both a public and private face to overcrowding...All the common spaces are overstrained. There are too many people in the dining halls, the libraries, the game rooms, music practice rooms, theater spaces, and athletic facilities.
>
> The private face of overcrowding is much darker and largely invisible to those members of the Yale Community who are not students. Put most simply, more students are living in many residential units than they were designed to accommodate. Quite often two students will sleep and study in a room approximately ten feet by seven feet in dimension. Some groups of three students adjust to

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the problem by dividing the use of a single room three ways over the course of the academic year. In other cases four students may inhabit space originally planned for two students.

In 1984 I was a member of a University Committee on the Future of the Residential Colleges. We found the situation to be the same as described by the Provost's subcommittee. To relieve the crowding we recommended the construction of an additional college, without increasing enrollment in Yale College. I still think that would be an excellent idea. To be sure, the building itself would be costly, and the added upkeep would increase the strain on the operating budget, but the benefit to the quality and security of student life would be very great, perhaps worth reducing expenses in other areas. Instead of slowing the pace of repair and renovation, instead of banning the construction of new buildings, a view of Yale's future that takes proper account of our student's needs would hasten the pace of renovation and act to relieve the crowding where they live and learn.

The Review Committee recommends cuts in administrative costs beyond those already accomplished and ordered: "Reducing the number of nonfaculty staff by an additional 3.5% would roughly compensate for scaling the faculty cuts to 5%." Once again, that is easy to say for those who will be inconvenienced by such cuts little or not at all. For the students of Yale College, however, they would be very painful. Students have accepted reductions in food service with tolerant grace but at some inconvenience. Further reductions would be intolerable. The Athletics Department has already made significant reductions and been forced to eliminate some varsity, junior varsity, and intramural sports. Further funding cuts would certainly deprive Yale students of valuable athletic opportunities. The libraries, which also require massive repair and renovation at once, have been compelled to reduce hours of service in some branches. Additional reductions can be expected to make the situation worse, at even greater cost to the education of our students.

In the office of Yale College itself we have had to reduce our budget by about $550,000 over the last two years. The reductions did not come easily. We were forced to eliminate the position of one of our associate deans and to impose her important and demanding responsibilities on the remaining associate and assistant deans, already fully occupied with other duties. Inevitably, they have had less time to serve the students who count on them, and we have already seen unwelcome effects. We reduced our support for student activities in the residential colleges, for undergraduate organizations, for the cultural centers, for the Yale College Council, and we eliminated the budget to support an all-campus social event. For anomalous historical reasons the budgets of several academic programs are part of the Yale College budget. We were, therefore, compelled to reduce the number of Accounting courses available to our students. An excellent and popular course on the study of the city was also marked for elimination until a generous alumnus made an anonymous donation that saved the day, a situation that will not last forever. All these reductions in areas of keen importance to our students have been accomplished before a single faculty position has been eliminated, but the Review Committee says, "Reduce the General Level of Staff Support."



*Further cuts in the Yale College staff would be very painful for undergraduates*

Nor is that the end. Yale College has been instructed to make a further reduction next year of over $300,000 and an additional cut of almost $200,000 for the following year, all this apart from the Review Committee's additional suggestion. Shall we cut support for student activities even more? Shall we stop supporting the Yale bands and symphony orchestra? Shall we eliminate Accounting entirely or get rid of the Theatre Studies courses and major, which are also part of the Yale College budget? Shall we eliminate one or more positions of the remaining Associate Deans, already overburdened by service absolutely essential to students and faculty? Shall we dismiss Assistant Deans who direct the cultural centers and perform similar essential services? I, at least, can not and will not make such recommendations, but the Review Committee says: "Reduce the General Level of Staff Support."

*A great many reductions in areas of keen importance to our students have been accomplished before a single faculty position has been eliminated*

The Review Committee says that our financial problems are not so serious. Perhaps they are right, although my own study of the evidence tells me it is even more serious than the Administration has suggested. But what if they are wrong? What if we do face a crisis or at least problems more serious than they see? What if deficits rise alarmingly? Won't we face the dangers of acting to meet an immediate emergency? Might that not lead to salary freezes, like those in California, hiring freezes

like those at Chicago and Penn? To capping financial aid for students, as suggested at Columbia? How does this compare with cutting faculty positions by 10%, through attrition alone, over a decade? Remember, these are positions filled and unfilled. The count in faculty positions now filled would be more like 8% over ten years. If conditions improved the cuts could be reduced even more, since the reductions are planned over a decade and could be reversed. But if we delay fixing the buildings, if we cut student activities and services, it is the students now and for decades to come who will suffer. I ask my colleagues in the faculty and administration to take this into account when they think about what should be done. Perhaps they will want to place somewhat greater importance than they have on the conditions facing Yale's students.

*Some faculty members, of course, think that too much attention is already being paid to Yale College and its students. They believe Yale should be more of a university and less of a college*

Some faculty members, of course, think that too much attention is already being paid to Yale College and its students. They believe Yale should be more of a university and less of a college. The model they often point to is Harvard, where the college does not have the pride of place it does at Yale. Their view is one element in the movement that led to the appointment of a new faculty committee on governance. Some members of that committee, I am told, are devoted to the Harvard model and will press for a new system dominated by a Dean of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, with the Deans of Yale College and of the Graduate School in greatly diminished subsidiary roles. That, indeed, is the Harvard system, and the thought of its adoption at Yale horrifies me.

The administration of the arts and sciences by a single Dean of the Faculty is common at American universities. In that system the President and the Provost allocate a budget to the arts and sciences and pretty well leave the rest to the Dean, and his title is not insignificant: he is the Dean of the Faculty. Decisions of policy and the allocation of resources are increasingly shaped by pressures from departments and individual faculty members, themselves motivated chiefly by considerations of prestige in their disciplines earned outside the university. Attention to the needs of undergraduate students, even in the form of teaching, are often seen as a distraction. Student affairs are usually relegated to a Dean of Students, who is not involved in major policy decisions, has nothing to say about the use of resources, and who may not even be a professor. Small wonder at the drift away from attention to liberal education and undergraduate concerns at such universities.

The structure of Yale is very different. There is no Dean of the Faculty. The arts and sciences are administered jointly by the President, the Provost, the Dean of the Graduate School, and the Dean of Yale College. Here a group makes the decisions on policy and resource allocation that elsewhere a single Dean of the Faculty makes alone. Our system has its disadvantages, but it has one great advantage: these important decisions are influenced by the participation of the Dean of Yale College. Here, too, the title is not insignificant. He is not the Dean of the faculty but of the college. His responsibility is to the interests of the undergraduate students no less than to their faculty, and those interests are not always identical. He is responsible for the quality of undergraduate education and the quality of student life. It is his charge to see that the cause of liberal education is not forgotten when major decisions and allocations are made, and he carries these responsibilities with him when he deliberates with his administrative colleagues.

At the faculty meeting where the new Committee on Governance was suggested its proposer complained that our traditional structure is old fashioned, suitable, perhaps, for the old days when Yale was chiefly an undergraduate college but antiquated now that it has become a great research university. I agree that the structure is old-fashioned–in the same way that devotion to the centrality of liberal education has become old fashioned at universities throughout this country. It is by adhering to that old idea and to the structure that has supported it these many years, however, that Yale has become the unique place it is, the envy of others around the world. Others have more funds, larger faculties, bigger research facilities, but everyone knows that for the best liberal undergraduate education in the setting of a great research faculty that is also devoted to teaching undergraduates, you should come to Yale. Will that still be true if we undermine the administrative structure that has made Yale what it is?

The single thing that most attracted me to Yale almost a quarter-century ago was its richly deserved reputation for devotion to the centrality of the liberal education of undergraduates in

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the context of a great research university enriched by the presence of excellent professional schools that also serve their interests. Not for me are the universities where the undergraduates need a passport to see a professor, where their instruction is left mainly to graduate students or to themselves. But that is the likely outcome when there is no one, ex officio, who is a powerful advocate for undergraduate education in the administration to counterbalance the magnetic force exercised by their disciplines upon an increasingly imperial professoriate, pulled away from the interests of undergraduates by demands and rewards outside the college and even the university.

Yale's unique greatness lies in its continued devotion to the liberal education of undergraduates, even as it has become an international center of scientific research and humanistic scholarship. Yale College is the jewel in the crown of our university, the one element that most significantly sets it apart from the competition. Yale's tradition and greatness are now threatened by a movement that aims to reduce it to the status of most other research universities, where undergraduate education is only one among many activities that are equally or even more important, perhaps to that of some where it is only an afterthought.

I take this opportunity to warn of the institutional, governmental threat that lies in wait for us, but the immediate threat arising from our financial problems and the way we try to meet them is now upon us and is no less dangerous. The most important elements in Yale's greatness are the quality of its students and faculty. The quality, I say, not the quantity. Marginally to increase or to decrease the number of either body is of little significance. The numbers of both have fluctuated over time without great harm. But if financial adversity leads to a decline in the compensation or quality of life of our faculty, outstanding faculty members will leave more readily than if their departments are a bit smaller than they would like. The resulting loss in quality will far outweigh any advantage provided by greater numbers. And if we allow the quality of undergraduate life and our commitment to undergraduate education to deteriorate we will surely lose our greatest asset: Yale's attraction for the most outstanding students who seek a liberal education. I appeal to my faculty colleagues who have been carried away by the excitement of the moment, to administrators who need to withstand their onslaught, and to the members of the Yale Corporation, who have the final responsibility, to take a broader and a longer view. Do not sacrifice the needs of our undergraduates.

It has been a great honor to serve as Dean of Yale College. I am grateful to have had the opportunity to work toward our common educational and scholarly goals with the magnificent students and splendid faculty of this great university. I am especially grateful to the talented and tirelessly dedicated men and women on the staff of Yale College. Few know how superbly they serve our students and faculty and how much they contribute to our mission. It has been a privilege to work with them. I have decided, however, that I have now achieved as much as I can in my present position and that it is time for me to return fully to teaching and scholarship and to my favorite position for defending the values of a liberal education in the Yale tradition, to the back benches of the faculty. I have, therefore, told President Schmidt that at the end of this academic year I will retire as Dean of Yale College.

Thank you and good night.

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# GESO Deserves a Voice, not a Veto



*Kevin Delaney*

The Yale Graduate School is not run democratically. Neither are thousands of graduate programs throughout the United States. From some students' perspectives, the hierarchy of University decision-making may appear particularly ungenerous. There are no elections for administrators or plebiscites on their policy-making. Which is as it should be.

This is not to say that graduate students do not influence the policies, appointments, curriculum, and day-to-day operations of the school. The 12 April report of the Graduate School Executive Committee brings even greater tangible influence and power to the hands of Yale graduate students. Some say the recommendations do not sufficiently safeguard or institutionalize student power, some that the power is still not extensive enough. But it would be difficult to deny that student input into administrative decisions will increase as a result of the report. It addresses major concerns raised by the Graduate Employees and Students Organization (GESO) and others, and itself reveals the Administration's recognition of the importance of student discussion to graduate school decision-making.

*It would be difficult to deny that student input into administrative decisions will increase as a result of the report*

At the heart of the committee's recommendations are proposals for student presence on major policy and judicial committees, and for the creation of a new graduate student government. The report cites the necessity of a "level playing field" for graduate student discussion and representation through a student government, and asserts the necessity of combining majority rule with minority protections. It mandates a constitutional convention with proportional representation from departments and specifies that 75 percent of all students must approve the final constitution. Students would be allowed to sit on the Graduate School committees only after the new student government was formed.

Current apathy toward the Graduate and Professional Schools Senate (GPSS) and some students' disillusionment and disagreement with GESO means that neither provides a reliable picture of student opinion. The new government is aimed at providing a forum more representative of graduate students' interests, one that would "serve as their institutional voice within the university."[1] Although the report claims that the government would not be designed to compete with or replace current organizations, the creation of another graduate student voice would challenge both GESO and GPSS. Although GESO claims that nearly 60 percent of students are GESO members, GESO's own role in the new government is still unclear.

Graduate student power is the real issue behind the proposal, according to GESO spokesman Gordon Lafer. He sees the new government as powerless, important mainly for nominating students for committee posts. "You don't need a constitutional convention to create a nominating committee," he said. Students need an organization or institutional structure for negotiating with the University, according to Lafer, a structure the report explicitly condemns: "We do *not* conceive of student membership on committees as a form of collective bargaining, with students on one side opposing administrators and faculty members on the other."[2] In Lafer's eyes, students should serve on committees as representatives of the students and pursue the students' agenda.

Lafer said he would accept a representative organization with the power of collective bargaining behind it. He asserts the importance of pressuring the Administration to achieving results and cites the report as evidence of GESO's success using this tactic. "The Administration

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doesn't move until it's pushed, but when it's pushed, it moves," he said. According to Lafer, the crucial difference between GESO and a graduate student government is that GESO has a grass-roots organizing structure which enables it to take collective action.

Governance of the Graduate School is at stake. However instrumental was GESO's role in securing gains for students, it is difficult to support the creation of structures for collective bargaining between the administration and students. Such structures could cripple decision-making, forcing administrators to bargain with students over issues such as academic policies and appointments. Graduate students are adults, but they do not possess the experience and responsibility of most administrators. And although they should contribute to discussions of policies, graduate students do not deserve veto power over administrative decisions.

GESO has already demonstrated the lengths to which it will go to pressure the administration. Over $100,000 in aid from Locals 34 and 35 has already been put toward GESO endeavors. The association with the labor unions is not accidental. GESO aims at achieving union negotiating power if not union status. This campaign for power has already disrupted the campus in the form of strikes. It has also demonstrated GESO's willingness to manipulate and misinform its membership. Collective bargaining is not an appropriate technique for handling academic issues and GESO's adoption of labor tactics is a further cause for concern. The Graduate School is entrusted with responsibility for graduate students' education and its administrators should be accountable to outside committees, faculty votes, and University supervision. But the institutionalization of collective bargaining Lafer envisions would be dangerous for the University community, pitting students against both faculty and administrators. The threat to the decision-making process proceeds not from administrative or faculty politicking so much as from politicization of the issues by graduate students, GESO in particular. In the end, the creation of the new government and the granting of a student presence on policy-making and judicial committees will go further toward ensuring that students' voices are heard.

The new student government's future is uncertain. Graduate students would have to respond to the committee's call and draft a constitution which met both the committee's specifications and those of most students. Given the insistence on a mutually agreeable forum, the creation of the new government might prove painful. GESO will continue to pressure the administration from the outside. Yale could terminate student membership on committees should students appear to advance an agenda. Should the new government survive these challenges and develop into a true intermediary between students and the Dean of the Graduate School, however, then it will prove invaluable. The potential exists, but difficult politicking lies ahead.

The faculty's role in decision-making is for the moment unclear. According to Dean of the Graduate School Judith Rodin, the committee's recommendations aim to decentralize control of the Graduate School and "let departments put their own imprimatur back on the policy." She said she sees the Graduate School's role as coordinating policy-guiding discussion and leaving implementation and many specific decisions to the departments. Already, departments have been asked to submit reports on student and educational concerns and recommendations for time-to-degree policies. Lafer does not agree that the report itself guarantees greater departmental involvement: "In no departmental area have the faculty been given the authority to make policy."

Yale graduate students bear the bruises of recent indignities. The Administration's decision to fill Hall of Undergraduate Studies (HGS) housing with undergraduates rightly provoked graduate student ire. Haphazard implementation of the Pollitt Plan over the past year has placed unacceptable expectations on some teaching assistants, damaging graduate student morale and undergraduate education. The closing of Lords dining facility destroyed a popular student meeting place. The transformation of University Career Services into Undergraduate Career Services left many graduate students without clear resources for career assistance. It was understandable that some students felt Yale's commitment to undergraduate education and its obsession with budget cuts spelled neglect and mistreatment for the Graduate School.

Executive Committee recommendations address many of these issues. The report includes provisions for greater Graduate School control over student housing and for the expansion of Graduate School fellowship



*Collective bargaining is not an appropriate technique for handling academic issues and GESO's adoption of labor tactics is a grave cause for concern*

and career services. Through the report's recommendations, the Administration has exhibited stronger financial commitment to graduate students. The committee recommended a 10% raise in teaching fellow salaries for 1992-93 and the creation of a new teaching fellow rank which would provide some graduate students with larger salaries. The Provost has already approved its recommendation to limit the graduate tuition increase to 5% for next year.

Several of the committee's recommendations come almost directly from the 28 February 1990 Pollitt Plan. But the new recommendations address the major faults in the implementation of the Pollitt Plan and constitute a vindication of the Plan's initial goals. The Executive Committee reasserted Yale's commitment to dissertation fellowships, financial awards designed to allow students to take a year off from teaching fellow positions to speed the completion of their degrees. This policy was wisely renewed, for recent studies indicate that reduction in years spent as teaching fellows is crucial to an increase in the number of doctorates awarded.[3]

The recommendations also provide for the creation of teacher training programs for graduate students modeled after the Bass training workshops. Teacher training coordinated through the Graduate School, an important concern of the 25 April 1989 Prown Report, has been largely neglected over the past year. The Executive Committee's report appoints administrators to oversee the program's creation.

*It is reasonable to expect students to complete their dissertations within the six-year limit*

The Executive Committee backed off from Pollitt Plan's limits on the number of years graduate students would be permitted to enroll before earning their degrees. Citing a trend of increasing time-to-degree, the original plan placed a strict six-year cap on enrollment. The Executive Committee requested reports from faculty-student departmental committees regarding reasonable time-to-degree expectations for each specific department. A Graduate School Course of Study Committee will examine the reports and determine time limits for each department. The trend is clearly away from strict time-to-degree limits, which is unfortunate. It is reasonable to expect students to complete their dissertations within the framework of a six-year limit, and extensions of this limit may well do more harm than good.

The quality of undergraduate education would presumably improve with greater teacher training and monitoring of section sizes. Dean Rodin said that the total teaching fellow cuts will not reach the 20% total projected by the Pollitt Plan, but that total cuts are closer to 12-14%. The Executive Committee does not specify the measures it proposes to take should section sizes grow unacceptably. The average size of Political Science sections, 21 last semester, has already grown larger than Yale's stated limits on section sizes for that department. The University needs to institute stronger policies on size limits and to assist departments with strategies for dealing with them.

Both graduate students and faculty will have the opportunity to vote on the provisions. GESO is sponsoring a line-item referendum for all graduate students on 23 April and the faculty will discuss and vote on the recommendations on 5 May. The GESO vote will serve as an indication of student reaction to the report, but plays no official role in the approval process. Lafer said graduate student reaction to the recommendations is still unclear because non-GESO students have never been polled directly on these issues. Faculty acceptance of the plan would put it into effect.

Cultivating widespread involvement and consensus prior to graduate school decisions and recommendations is an appropriate policy. In this case, the committee's efforts to involve graduate students in its deliberations appear to have been effective at avoiding controversy from the outset. Rodin said that she issued the report nearly one month before the faculty's vote to allow for discussion and comment within the community.

But despite the importance of consensus, the Graduate School administration and faculty must have the freedom to make uncompromised and unpopular decisions. Graduate students must have a recognized and representative forum for registering complaints with the administration. But they must not have the veto power institutionalizing collective bargaining would allow them. Yale should not be forced to negotiate its curriculum or academic policies.

*Notes*

[1] 10 April 1992 Graduate School Executive Committee Report, p.30.

[2] *Ibid.*, p.29.

[3] DePalma, Anthony. "Shortage of Professors is Envisioned." NYT, 22 January 1992: A18.

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# Book Review

## *The End of History and the Last Man*



*The End of History and the Last Man*
by Francis Fukuyama
The Free Press, 1992.

When Francis Fukuyama published his article entitled "The End of History" in the summer 1989 *National Interest*, he received an unexpectedly vigorous response. The essay, which reflected on the dramatic downfall of communist regimes in Eastern Europe, attracted wide attention for its bold claim. Fukuyama's central thesis was that history, as the record of conflict stemming from contradictions within human societies, was more or less ending with the triumph of political and economic liberalism. Most readers were generally skeptical that the way of life embodied in Western industrial democracies could represent any final stage in the development of societies or that humanity was actually advancing in history. To put forth such a claim seemed both naive and presumptuous.

In *The End of History and the Last Man*, Fukuyama has addressed many of these criticisms and set forth a far-reaching theory that purports to explain much of recent history in a rational scheme based generally on Hegelian philosophy. In the first part of the book, he examines the evidence drawn from political events around the world in the aftermath of World War II, particularly in the last two decades, that some sort of historical evolution is going on. It is immediately evident that free-market economics has spread dramatically from East Asia to Latin America. And communism, the chief alternative to capitalism, has more or less collapsed from internal rot. Political liberalism has also made dramatic gains on the world scene. There are now nearly five times as many democracies worldwide than there were in 1940.

Because of the weight of this evidence, Fukuyama argues that we may conceive a Universal History, a theory of historical evolution along the lines set forth by Hegel. According to Fukuyama, two fundamental forces–the "logic of modern science" and the universal human desire for recognition–drive historical progress. The logic of modern science is the progressive application of scientific discoveries to practical problems, yielding continuous technological advance. It is this mechanism of technological progress that led to the Industrial Revolution and the eventual development of consumerist, free-market economies.

This mechanism, however, cannot account for the proliferation of political liberalism. What prompts people to demand rights, to call for liberty and equality, is a fundamental desire for recognition, to be acknowledged by others. While in former ages this desire accounted for the continual power struggles provoked by lords and aristocrats, the desire in modernity has led the masses of humanity, formerly slaves, to demand *equal* recognition for all. It is this desire alone that can explain the general drift toward democracy in states that are relatively prosperous, such as Taiwan and South Korea. Fukuyama argues that there is indeed an important correlation between the development of prosperous industrial economies and the establishment of democracy, but economic conditions alone are not sufficient to guarantee the creation of political liberalism; one must take into account the desire for recognition to explain the phenomenon of democracy.

In the last portion of his book, Fukuyama takes up the important question of whether the modern democratic capitalist state can be really satisfying to the human spirit and

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*George Collins is a Sophomore in Silliman.*

consequently represents an end point of historical evolution. In such a society, there arises what Fukuyama terms the "last man," a *bourgeois* animal who is content to labor in anonymity, enjoying in his spare moments the banalities of mass culture. Nietzsche saw such men as the ultimate embodiment of the slave mentality. While Fukuyama does not criticize modern man with such unabashed contempt, he points out that the life of such men is for the most part hollow and spiritless. We are led to suppose that the spirited part of the last man finds outlets in all sorts of vainglorious pursuits like entrepreneurship and marathon running. There is reason to doubt that such pursuits are ultimately satisfying. Consequently we are left wondering if "post-historical" society may not eventually collapse and give rise to historical turmoil created by discontents who seek power and glory.

Fukuyama's arguments, contrary to what one might expect from such a bold and sweeping thesis, are sober and informed by a wide-ranging grasp of recent history and political theory. His reflections on the actual conditions of "post-historical" life and whether they are ultimately satisfying do not diminish the scope of his central thesis, but they do demonstrate a kind of self-conscious skepticism that is proper in an argument that essentially proclaims the triumph of societies like our own. Only the march of history in the next hundred years or more may validate Fukuyama's claims, but as the world stands today, the theory represents an insightful, perhaps brilliant, understanding of recent history as well as an informed, theoretical justification for economic and political liberalism.

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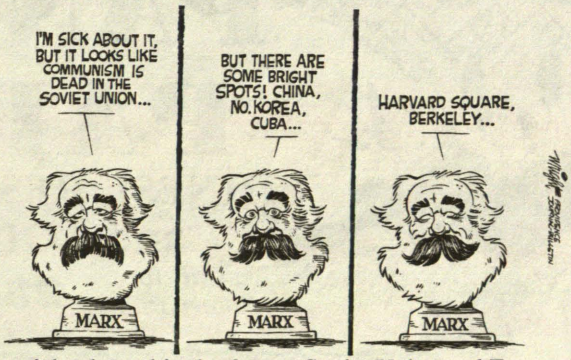


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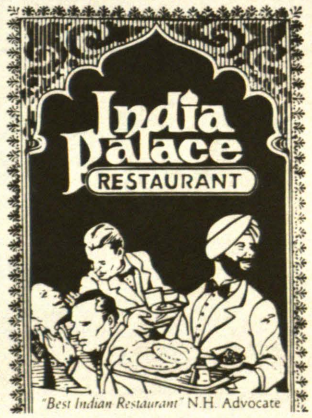


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